

Fieldstate Structure Options - Comparison

This document compares four commercial structures for funding and owning Fieldstate. It is a discussion draft, not a legal agreement or legal advice. All terms are indicative and subject to counsel review. Not legal advice.

Executive summary

There are four clean routes:

1. Option A - NewCo Founder-Led: best if the investor wants a long-term company asset and Razim remains founder/operator.
2. Option B - Build + Transfer Option: best if investor wants first right to buy while Razim keeps IP during the build.
3. Option C - Full IP Assignment: best if investor wants asset acquisition or work-for-hire style ownership, priced accordingly.
4. Option D - Equal Founder Optics + Build Option: best if Vlad needs visible founder-level protection while investor still gets a staged path to larger ownership.

Retainer pays for delivery time. IP transfer or company ownership is a separate commercial term.

Comparison table

Table:

*** Topic | Option A - NewCo | Option B - Build Option | Option C - Assignment | Option D - Founder Optics**

Best for | Investable company | First right while terms mature | Outright asset control | Vlad/Razim both need founder recognition

IP during build | Razim/NewCo transition | Razim retains IP | Razim retains IP | Razim retains IP

IP after trigger | NewCo owns IP | Transfers only if exercised and paid | Transfers after payment/escrow | NewCo or assignment after option exercise

Razim economics | Founder equity + retainer | Retainer + option/buyout economics | High cash + retainer + optional low equity | Founder economics tied to build/product delivery

Vlad economics | Commercial role to agree | Commercial upside to agree | Usually separate | Founder/commercial economics tied to milestones

Investor comfort | Company owns asset | Paid exclusivity / purchase option | Full ownership after payment | First shot plus cap-table path to larger ownership

Indicative retainer | GBP 6.4k/month discounted founder rate | GBP 6.4k/month discounted founder rate; market equivalent GBP 10k-18k | GBP 12k-25k/month | GBP 10k-18k/month for Razim delivery

Indicative upfront | Stage 1 funding into NewCo | GBP 15k-25k option fee | Escrow/deposit | GBP 15k-25k option fee

Indicative IP price | Reflected in company equity | GBP 250k-750k buyout | GBP 300k-750k+ assignment | GBP 250k-750k if converting to buyout

Key risk | Founder documents must protect role | Investor may delay decision | Underpriced contractor trap | Equal optics without contribution vesting

Protection needed | Founder vesting, good-leaver, IP consent | Time limit, payment trigger | Escrow, carve-out, no broad non-compete | Milestone vesting, no selective dilution, no automatic Razim transfer

Investor economics: which route is the strongest deal for the investor?

Judged purely on investor risk and return, Option B is the strongest of the three:

- Lowest cost of being wrong. The investor's exposure at every point is only the

rungs already funded - and each rung delivered a real asset (demo, pilot, data, models). Options A and C both require committing at the point of maximum uncertainty: A prices equity on day one; C pays the full asset price before the market has proven anything.

- Highest value of being right. Each rung is bought at a **pre-agreed pricing formula**, not a renegotiated market price. If Fieldstate performs, the value created

between rungs accrues to the investor on exercise - the formula locks in tomorrow's position at terms agreed today. Option A gives no path beyond the initial stake; Option C captures all upside but only by paying peak price for unproven work upfront.

- Control without the acquisition premium. Option B reaches the same destination

as Option C - majority control, even full acquisition - but pays for it in stages, each priced after evidence, with exclusivity blocking any competing buyer for the cost of an option fee.

- The founder stays locked in and motivated the whole way. Under Option C the builder is paid out and gone; under Option B the founder's equity vests through every rung the investor funds - the investor's money and the founder's upside point the same direction until the end.

Option C is only the better deal if the investor is already certain today that Fieldstate succeeds - in which case the ladder's rung-5 acquisition delivers the same ownership with several evidence checkpoints in between. Option A is the better deal only for an investor who wants a conventional minority position and no control path.

What all options exclude unless stated

- Licensed football data fees.
- Advanced neural model training and GPU campaign costs.
- Legal fees, tax advice, accounting, company formation, and due diligence.
- Production infrastructure beyond the defined MVP or sprint scope.
- Commercial guarantees, club adoption guarantees, or model accuracy guarantees.

Recommended use

Use this comparison to choose the commercial shape before discussing detailed legal drafting. If the investor wants low equity for Razim, the fair alternative is higher cash, narrower rights, or delayed IP transfer.

Related drafts

- Option A - NewCo Founder-Led ([option-a-newco-founder-led.md](#))
- Option B - Build + Transfer Option ([option-b-build-transfer-option.md](#))
- Option C - Full IP Assignment ([option-c-full-ip-assignment.md](#))
- [Option D - Equal Founder Optics + Build Option]([option-d-equal-founder-optics.md](#))

Counsel review note

No document in this folder should be signed. These are commercial draft positions for discussion. Counsel should convert the selected route into proper legal documents.